Track 3: Autonomous AI Teammates

Build AI teammates that don't just respond; they get the job done

Design an AI teammate that can go beyond answering questions and deliver measurable outcomes in sales or customer service. The AI should understand context, make decisions, take actions, and work alongside human teams.

CLAUDE:

Restated: Build an AI that does the work, not one that answers questions. It should read context, decide, act in real tools (CRM, helpdesk, email, payments), and hand off to humans cleanly. You must prove it with numbers.

Who suffers: Reps spend only about 28% of their time selling (Salesforce). Support agents lose time re-reading history, copying data between tools, and chasing follow-ups.

Root cause: Answers aren’t the bottleneck. The last mile is: updating the CRM, issuing the refund, sending the follow-up, escalating on time. Humans do this because nobody trusts software to act.

Hidden need: Bounded trust. Teams won’t let an AI act unless it has limits, an audit trail, and undo. “Teammate” means it has a role, memory, a defined authority, and a KPI it owns. Most teams will build smart talk with no authority.

Judge keywords: action-taking, autonomy with guardrails, human-in-the-loop, measurable KPIs, context/memory, real workflow, before/after baseline.

STEP 2: SIMPLE EXAMPLE

Riya’s parcel is 4 days late. She messages three times and each agent asks for her order ID again. On day 5 she demands a refund and leaves a 1-star review. A real teammate would have seen the delay on day 2, apologized, issued a ₹100 credit (within its limit), and noted the case for the human who takes over.

STEP 3: THE GENERIC FIVE (AVOID)

1. **FAQ/support chatbot:** answers only, no action, and every team builds it.
2. **Lead-scoring/sales dashboard:** shows insight but does nothing with it.
3. **AI email writer:** a drafting tool, not a teammate.

4. **Ticket classifier/router:** useful but invisible, with no outcome to demo.
5. **Call summarizer/CRM note-taker:** this is now a commodity feature and doesn't "get the job done."

STEP 4: 7 UNIQUE SOLUTIONS

1. Shadow Intern

- **Core idea:** An AI junior that learns from your best agent's past resolutions, then handles tickets within a graduated authority ladder (suggest, then act on small cases, then act on bigger ones).
- **Different:** It is scored against historical human decisions (backtest), so the claim is evidence, not a promise.
- **Flow:** Ingest 500+ resolved tickets, extract the playbook, replay 200 held-out tickets, compare its decision and action to the human's, auto-act where confidence is high, and escalate with a pre-written brief otherwise.
- **Stack:** FastAPI, LLM tool-calling, SQLite, Streamlit/React, public support-ticket datasets (Bitext, Kaggle).
- **Demo:** Backtest scoreboard (agreement %, autonomy %), plus a live ticket resolved end-to-end against a mock helpdesk with an audit log.
- **Impact:** If it handles 40-60% of tier-1 tickets at 90%+ agreement, that is roughly 2-3 agent-hours saved per agent per day.
- **Why judges pick it:** Measurable, safe, and honest about trust.
- **Risk:** Agreement metrics look weak. Handle this by reporting "safe-action agreement" separately and showing the escalations as a feature.

2. COD Rescue Agent

- **Core idea:** An AI that WhatsApps or calls Cash-on-Delivery buyers in Hinglish before dispatch, confirms intent and address, and offers a prepaid discount.
- **Different:** It targets one hard Indian metric, return-to-origin (RTO, 20-30% on COD), instead of generic support.
- **Flow:** New COD order, risk score (pincode, order value, history), Hinglish chat, confirm or fix the address, send a payment link, release or hold the shipment, and flag high-value cases to a human.
- **Stack:** Python, LLM with Hinglish prompts, Twilio/WhatsApp sandbox (or a simulated chat UI), Razorpay test mode.
- **Demo:** A live chat flipping an order from "risky" to "prepaid confirmed", plus a simulated 1,000-order impact table.

- **Impact:** Each RTO costs about ₹150-250 in shipping and handling. Cutting RTO by 25% on 10k orders a month saves about ₹4-6 lakh.
- **Why judges pick it:** A local, quantifiable pain, and the action is real money.
- **Risk:** WhatsApp approval takes too long. Use the sandbox or a simulated chat UI, and label simulated data clearly.

3. Deal Defibrillator

- **Core idea:** An AI that finds stalled deals, diagnoses why they stalled, and runs the right revival move.
- **Different:** It focuses on silence, the signal everyone ignores, and chooses between several actions.
- **Flow:** Scan the pipeline for no-reply deals over 10 days, read the thread to get the stall reason (price, timing, champion left), pick a play (case study, discount request to the manager, new contact), draft and send, then book a call if the prospect replies.
- **Stack:** Python, Gmail/Calendar API or mocks, LLM, a CRM mock (HubSpot free tier).
- **Demo:** 10 mock stalled deals, each with a visible diagnosis and chosen action.
- **Impact:** Reviving even 10-15% of stalled pipeline is often worth more than new lead gen.
- **Why judges pick it:** Clear sales ROI.
- **Risk:** Emails read as spammy. Add an approval toggle and a tone check.

4. Promise Keeper

- **Core idea:** The AI detects commitments made in calls and chats (“I’ll send pricing Friday”) and then fulfills them.
- **Different:** It goes beyond note-taking to execute follow-through.
- **Flow:** Transcript in, extract promises plus deadline plus owner, generate the asset (quote, doc, invite), send it or queue it for human approval, and alert if the deadline is at risk.
- **Stack:** Whisper or a transcript file, LLM extraction, PDF generation, Calendar mock.
- **Demo:** A 3-minute sales call becomes a quote PDF plus a calendar invite plus a CRM update in under a minute.
- **Impact:** Missed follow-ups lose a meaningful share of deals, and this removes about 30 minutes of admin per call.
- **Why judges pick it:** Obvious, relatable, and visually satisfying.
- **Risk:** Close to the note-taker space. Differentiate by showing only the executed outputs.

5. Root-Cause Rallier

- **Core idea:** When 5+ tickets share a cause, the AI files an engineering bug with evidence and notifies affected customers when it’s fixed.

- **Different:** The support AI works with engineering, not just customers.
- **Flow:** Cluster the incoming tickets, detect a spike, open a Jira/GitHub issue with samples, send holding replies, and send fix updates on close.
- **Stack:** Embeddings plus clustering, GitHub API, LLM.
- **Demo:** A ticket flood simulation that auto-creates an issue.
- **Impact:** Cuts duplicate tickets 30-50% in incident scenarios.
- **Why judges pick it:** Cross-team autonomy is rare.
- **Risk:** Looks like a monitoring tool. Emphasize the customer-facing actions.

6. Discount Desk

- **Core idea:** The AI handles discount requests within margin guardrails and negotiates like a deal-desk teammate.
- **Different:** It has real economic decision authority, not just text generation.
- **Flow:** Request in, check margin floor, deal size, and customer history, simulate profit impact, then approve, counter-offer, or escalate with a recommendation.
- **Stack:** Python rules plus LLM, a pricing table, a simple UI.
- **Demo:** A negotiation with a live margin meter.
- **Impact:** Approval cycles drop from days to minutes, which means faster closes.
- **Why judges pick it:** Shows decision-making with clear constraints.
- **Risk:** Hard to test. Use synthetic pricing and state it openly.

7. Handoff Baton

- **Core idea:** A living case file that follows each customer and briefs whoever picks up next.
- **Different:** It treats the handoff, where most customer frustration begins, as the product.
- **Flow:** Merge chat, email, and call history into a timeline, summarize intent, sentiment, and promises, brief the next agent, and pre-draft the next action.
- **Stack:** LLM summarization, a vector store.
- **Demo:** Handoff between two simulated agents with zero re-asking.
- **Impact:** Cuts average handle time 20-30% by removing repeated questions.
- **Why judges pick it:** Easy to understand.
- **Risk:** Passive, since it reads but rarely acts. Add auto-actions.

STEP 5: RANKING AND FINAL PICK

Rank	Solution	Why
1	**Shadow Intern**	Proven numbers, safe autonomy, matches “work alongside humans”

Rank	Solution	Why
2	COD Rescue Agent	Strong local impact and a vivid demo; riskier on integration
3	Deal Defibrillator	Clear sales ROI
4	Promise Keeper	Great demo, near a crowded space
5	Discount Desk	Real decisions, weak data
6	Root-Cause Rallier	Novel but a narrower fit
7	Handoff Baton	Too passive

Build Shadow Intern. It is the only option that answers the question judges will ask every team: “How do we know it works and is safe?” Your backtest scoreboard is the proof, and the authority ladder is the trust story.

Demo order (3 minutes):

1. Show the backtest numbers.
2. Run one live ticket end-to-end.
3. Show one deliberate escalation.
4. Show the audit log and undo.

If your team is more e-commerce/India-focused, swap in COD Rescue as the pick.

GPT:

Solutions

These concepts are tailored to your team's likely strengths in Kotlin, JavaScript, web development, APIs, databases, and AI integration.

1. GhostLead — The AI That Resurrects Lost Customers

Core idea: An AI teammate identifies customers who showed interest but never completed a purchase. It determines why they dropped off and initiates an appropriate recovery workflow.

What makes it different?

Most sales agents focus on new leads. This one focuses on revenue businesses have already lost.

How it works:

1. Import sample CRM records and customer conversations.
2. Detect leads that have gone inactive.
3. Classify likely reasons: price concerns, unanswered questions, or forgotten follow-ups.
4. Generate personalized follow-up messages.
5. Execute simulated follow-ups and update lead statuses.
6. Show recovered opportunities and estimated revenue.

Tech stack: React, TypeScript, Node.js, MongoDB, an LLM API, and a simulated email or messaging integration.

Realistic demo: Upload 100 sample leads and demonstrate how the agent prioritizes and processes them.

Potential impact: If 5 of 100 inactive leads convert and each generates ₹2,000, that's ₹10,000 in recovered revenue. This is an illustrative scenario, not a guaranteed result.

Why judges might select it: Clear business value, measurable outcomes, and a complete action-oriented workflow.

Biggest risk: Fabricated revenue claims. Clearly distinguish simulated conversions from actual results.

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2. PromiseKeeper — The AI That Never Forgets a Customer Promise

Core idea: Businesses frequently promise customers callbacks, refunds, updates, or delivery confirmations and then forget.

Build an AI teammate that tracks every promise and ensures it is fulfilled.

What makes it different?

Instead of answering incoming queries, it proactively prevents customer dissatisfaction.

How it works:

1. Ingest sample customer conversations.
2. Extract promises, deadlines, and responsible employees.

3. Create actionable tasks automatically.
4. Monitor task deadlines.
5. Execute permitted actions or remind the responsible employee.
6. Escalate overdue promises.

Tech stack: React, Node.js, MongoDB, an LLM API, and scheduled background jobs.

Realistic demo: Process 30 conversations, extract commitments, and display a live resolution queue.

Potential impact: If the system prevents 20 missed commitments monthly, it could reduce follow-up workload and customer dissatisfaction. Validate the actual reduction through testing.

Why judges might select it: It solves an overlooked problem through proactive autonomy rather than reactive conversation.

Biggest risk: Incorrectly extracting commitments. Require confidence thresholds and human approval for ambiguous cases.

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3. SilentSOS — The AI That Detects Customers About to Leave

Core idea: An AI teammate detects signs of customer frustration before the customer formally complains or cancels.

It takes appropriate recovery actions before the relationship deteriorates.

What makes it different?

Most customer service systems react to complaints. This agent attempts to prevent them.

How it works:

1. Analyze sample conversations and customer histories.
2. Detect repeated issues, negative sentiment, and unresolved requests.
3. Estimate customer churn risk.
4. Select an appropriate recovery action.
5. Offer a permitted remedy or escalate to a human.
6. Track whether the issue was resolved.

Tech stack: React, TypeScript, Node.js, MongoDB, an LLM API, and a rule-based risk engine.

Realistic demo: Feed 20 synthetic customer histories into the system and demonstrate how it identifies high-risk customers and initiates recovery workflows.

Potential impact: Demonstrate how many high-risk cases are identified and resolved in a test dataset. Don't claim actual churn reduction without real-world evidence.

Why judges might select it: Combines customer service, predictive reasoning, and autonomous intervention.

Biggest risk: Misinterpreting sentiment. Combine multiple signals instead of relying on sentiment analysis alone.

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4. ReturnShield — The AI That Prevents Refunds Before They Happen

Core idea: An AI teammate investigates why customers request refunds or returns and attempts to resolve eligible issues before processing a return.

What makes it different?

Instead of simply processing complaints, it identifies opportunities to resolve the underlying problem.

How it works:

1. Receive a sample refund request.
2. Retrieve the order and applicable refund policy.
3. Determine the customer's issue.
4. Identify permitted alternatives, such as troubleshooting or a replacement.
5. Present the appropriate option to the customer.
6. Execute approved actions or escalate the case.

Tech stack: React, Node.js, MongoDB, an LLM API, and a policy-based decision engine.

Realistic demo: Simulate 20 refund cases and demonstrate how the agent handles each according to policy.

Potential impact: Measure how many cases are resolved without a refund and how much processing time is saved.

Why judges might select it: It connects AI decisions directly to operational costs and customer outcomes.

Biggest risk: Appearing to obstruct legitimate refunds. Always respect customer rights, refund policies, and escalation requirements.

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5. ShiftPilot — The AI Teammate That Takes Over When Employees Leave

Core idea: When an employee's shift ends, unresolved customer conversations and pending commitments are automatically transferred to the next available employee with full context.

What makes it different?

The AI solves a coordination problem between humans rather than merely replacing individual tasks.

How it works:

1. Import customer conversations and employee assignments.
2. Identify unresolved issues and pending commitments.
3. Generate concise handover summaries.
4. Prioritize urgent cases.
5. Assign cases to appropriate employees.
6. Track acceptance and resolution.

Tech stack: React, TypeScript, Node.js, MongoDB, and an LLM API.

Realistic demo: Simulate a shift change involving 20 unresolved customer cases.

Potential impact: Measure handover preparation time, missed commitments, and time to case acceptance.

Why judges might select it: Human-AI collaboration is built into the product rather than added as an afterthought.

Biggest risk: Incorrect handovers. Preserve original conversations and allow employees to inspect the AI-generated summaries.

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6. VoiceLedger — The AI That Turns Sales Calls Into Completed Work

Core idea: After a sales call, the AI converts the conversation into concrete business actions rather than merely producing a transcript.

What makes it different?

It connects spoken conversations directly to business execution.

How it works:

1. Upload a recorded or sample sales conversation.
2. Transcribe the audio.
3. Extract customer requirements, objections, and commitments.
4. Update the lead record.
5. Create follow-up tasks and draft a personalized message.
6. Execute approved actions and display the completed workflow.

Tech stack: React, Node.js, a speech-to-text API, an LLM API, and MongoDB.

Realistic demo: Process three sample sales calls and show how each becomes an updated customer record with actionable next steps.

Potential impact: Compare the time required to manually process a call against the automated workflow.

Why judges might select it: A compelling demonstration of multiple AI capabilities working together to complete real tasks.

Biggest risk: Incorrect transcription or extracted commitments. Allow verification before important CRM updates or messages are sent.

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7. QueueZero — The AI That Eliminates Repetitive Support Work

Core idea: Instead of treating every customer query as a separate ticket, the AI identifies recurring problems and resolves the underlying issue across multiple affected customers.

What makes it different?

Most support agents handle individual tickets. This one looks for a shared problem and coordinates a broader response.

How it works:

1. Analyze a collection of support tickets.
2. Identify recurring problems.
3. Group affected customers.
4. Determine the likely cause using available evidence.
5. Recommend or execute an approved fix.
6. Notify affected customers and track resolution.

Tech stack: Python for clustering and analysis, React, Node.js, MongoDB, and an LLM API.

Realistic demo: Process 50 synthetic tickets, discover a common issue, and demonstrate how the agent coordinates a response.

Potential impact: Measure duplicate tickets identified, manual actions avoided, and resolution time.

Why judges might select it: It shifts the focus from resolving individual complaints to preventing entire categories of repetitive work.

Biggest risk: Grouping unrelated issues together. Require sufficient evidence before merging cases or sending bulk notifications.

STEP 5: Ranking and Final Pick

These rankings are strategic judgments, not measured probabilities of winning.

Rank	Solution	Selection potential	Why
1	**GhostLead**	Very high	Direct revenue impact, clear metrics, and an excellent end-to-end demo.
2	**PromiseKeeper**	Very high	Distinctive proactive behavior and straightforward implementation.
3	**QueueZero**	High	Demonstrates systemic problem-solving rather than individual responses.
4	**VoiceLedger**	High	Visually compelling, practical, and technically demonstrable.
5	**SilentSOS**	High	Strong customer-retention angle, but impact is harder to prove.
6	**ShiftPilot**	Moderate–high	Excellent human-AI collaboration, although less commercially distinctive.

Rank	Solution	Selection potential	Why
7	**ReturnShield**	Moderate–high	Strong operational value, but refund scenarios require careful policy handling.

🏆 My Final Pick: GhostLead

Build GhostLead: An Autonomous AI Sales Teammate That Recovers Lost Revenue.

Here's why I'd choose it for your team:

1. **Easy to understand:** Judges immediately understand the cost of losing interested customers.
2. **Actually autonomous:** The agent identifies leads, reasons about their inactivity, selects actions, follows up, and updates records.
3. **Measurable:** You can demonstrate leads processed, follow-ups completed, and potential revenue recovered.
4. **Feasible to build:** Your React, TypeScript, backend, database, and API experience is enough to build a convincing MVP without training a custom AI model.
5. **Excellent live demo:** Show a forgotten lead entering the system, the AI investigating its history, and the lead moving through an automated recovery workflow.

The feature that could make it stand out

Give GhostLead a limited budget of actions.

For example, it can send one follow-up, offer an approved discount only when eligible, and escalate a lead when the customer requests something outside its authority.

It must decide **which action is worth taking, not merely generate a message**.

Build a working simulation first, with actual database updates and a mock messaging service. Add a real integration if time permits.